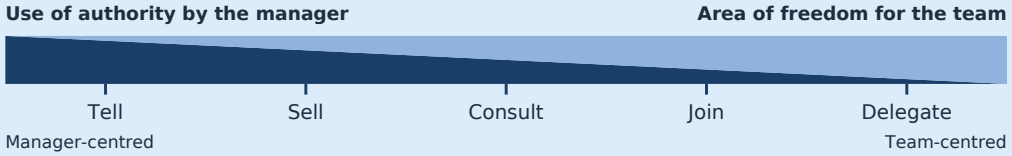
Model 1 3.2.1 | Tannenbaum Schmidt Continuum

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

A range of leadership behaviour from manager-centred (tell) to team-centred (delegate).



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Place the manager in the case on the continuum, then argue whether they should move towards tell or towards delegate for the decision being made.

Use the case: how urgent is the decision, how skilled are the staff, how risky is it?

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Shows leadership is not a choice between two fixed styles.

Highlights that the right point depends on the manager, the team and the situation.

Links to delegation, empowerment and motivation.

LIMITATIONS

Describes behaviour; it does not tell the manager what to do.

Ignores other factors such as culture and the wider organisation.

Real managers move along it for different decisions.

EXAM TRAP

Use the model's own stages (tell, sell, consult, join, delegate) when the question names it.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Move towards delegate → staff make more decisions → greater responsibility and commitment → quality of ideas improves → but slower decisions.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Say where the manager should be and what that depends on - time, skills and risk.

Model 2 3.2.2 | Scientific Decision Making

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT IS

A logical process for making decisions based on data:

Set objectives → gather data → analyse data → select strategy → implement → review, and back to the start.

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify the decision in the case and the data the business has or needs (market research, costs, forecasts).

Show how data would reduce the risk of the decision, then question how reliable that data is.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Reduces risk and personal bias.

Decisions can be explained and justified to others.

The review stage means lessons are learned.

LIMITATIONS

Data may be costly, out of date or unreliable.

Slow when a quick decision is needed.

Some factors - ethics, morale, reputation - are hard to put into numbers.

Experience and intuition may be more useful when there is little data.

EXAM TRAP

A scientific decision is not guaranteed to be right. It is only as good as the data and assumptions behind it.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Reliable research data → better estimate of demand → right price and output chosen → less waste → higher profit.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

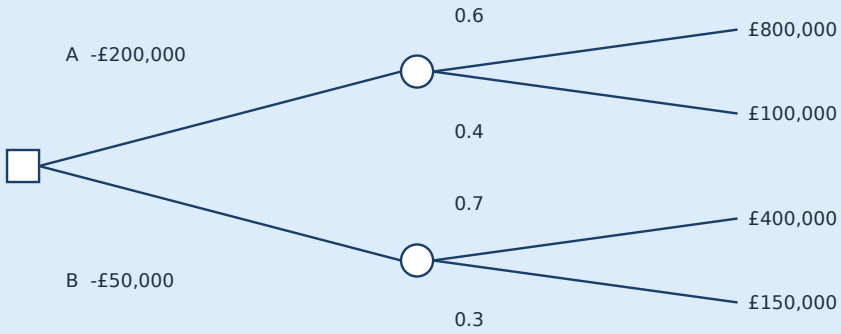
Most decisions combine data and judgement. Weigh how good the data is against how fast the decision has to be made.

Model 3 3.2.2 | Decision Trees

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

Options (squares), chance outcomes (circles), probabilities and pay-offs.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Expected value = sum of (probability × pay-off). Net gain = expected value - cost.

Calculate the net gain of each option and say which is higher.

Then look at the worst outcome of each option and the source of the probabilities.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Sets out options and outcomes clearly.

Puts numbers on risk.

Makes managers consider what could go wrong.

LIMITATIONS

Probabilities and pay-offs are estimates.

Expected value is an average that will never actually happen.

Ignores qualitative factors and the business's attitude to risk.

EXAM TRAP

Net gain is expected value minus cost - not total pay-off minus cost.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Higher net gain → financially the better option → but a higher-risk option may be unaffordable if it fails → cautious firm may choose the lower net gain.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

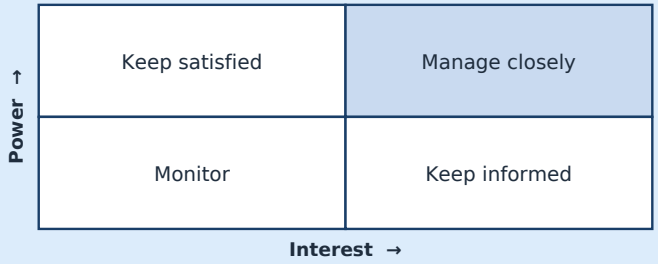
Judge the spread of outcomes and the reliability of the estimates, not just the expected value.

Model 4 3.2.3 | Stakeholder Mapping

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WHAT IT SHOWS

Stakeholders placed by power and interest.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify the decision in the case and place the main stakeholders on the grid.

Explain which group the business must manage most closely and why, and how it should communicate or consult with them.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Helps prioritise time and communication.

Shows who could block a decision.

Helps plan consultation before major changes.

LIMITATIONS

A snapshot - power and interest change over time.

Placing groups is a matter of judgement.

Groups are not all alike; individuals within them differ.

EXAM TRAP

Call it stakeholder mapping, as the AQA spec does. Power and interest are separate measures.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Employees high power and high interest in a restructure → manage closely through consultation → less resistance → smoother change.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

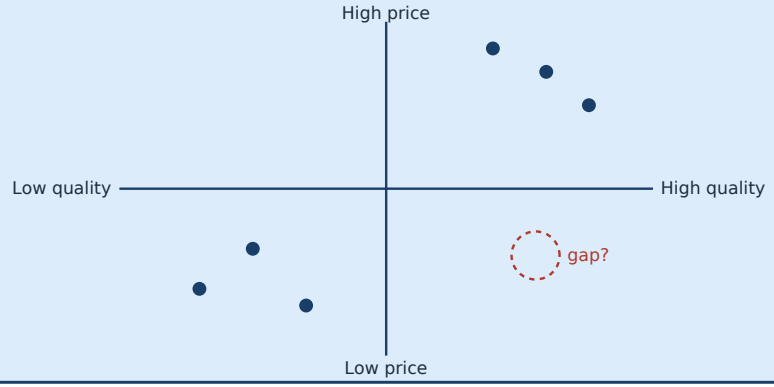
Ask how a group's position could change - e.g. social media giving customers more power.

Model 5 3.3.3 | Market Mapping

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

Brands placed on two axes that matter to customers.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Choose axes that matter to customers in the market in the case, e.g. price and quality, or traditional and modern.

Use the map to identify gaps, clusters of competitors, and how to position a product.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Shows where competitors are positioned.

Identifies possible gaps in the market.

Supports positioning and targeting decisions.

LIMITATIONS

Only two variables at a time.

Positions are often based on opinion rather than data.

A gap may exist because there is no demand there.

EXAM TRAP

A gap on the map is not proof of an opportunity. There must be enough customers who want that combination.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Map shows few competitors in the premium segment → business positions a new product there → less direct competition → higher margins, if demand exists.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Judge the map by how well its axes reflect what customers actually value.

Model 6 3.3.2 | Price & Income Elasticity of Demand

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

PRICE ELASTICITY (PED)

How much quantity demanded responds to a change in price.

Elastic (above 1, ignoring the sign) - quantity changes by a bigger % than price. Inelastic (below 1) - by a smaller %.

Inelastic: price rise increases revenue. Elastic: price cut increases revenue.

INCOME ELASTICITY (YED)

How much quantity demanded responds to a change in income.

Positive - normal goods. Above 1 - demand rises faster than income.

Negative - inferior goods: demand falls as income rises.

USING THEM IN AN ANSWER

You interpret values; you are not asked to calculate them.

E.g. PED -0.4, price up 10% → quantity down 4% → revenue rises.

E.g. YED -0.5, incomes up 4% → quantity down 2%.

LIMITATIONS

Values are estimates based on past data.

They change over time and with competitors' actions.

Other factors affecting demand may change at the same time.

EXAM TRAP

Inferior goods have negative YED. Inelastic does not mean demand doesn't change.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Strong brand → fewer close substitutes in customers' minds → demand more price inelastic → price can rise with a smaller fall in sales → revenue rises.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Elasticity is not fixed. Judge how reliable the estimate is and how long it will stay true.

Model 7 3.3.3 | Segmentation, Targeting & Positioning

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

SEGMENTATION

Dividing the market into groups. AQA methods: demographic, geographic, income and behavioural.

TARGETING

Choosing which segment(s) to serve - niche or mass marketing - based on size, growth, competition and the firm's resources.

POSITIONING

Deciding how the product should be seen compared with rivals, often using a market map.

VALUE AND LIMITATIONS

Value - clearer target, better matched marketing mix, less wasted spending.

Limitations - customers may not fit neat segments; research costs money; a narrow target can leave the business exposed if the segment shrinks.

EXAM TRAP

Segmentation is not just describing customers. Show how the chosen segment changes the marketing mix.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Clear target segment → mix designed for its needs → stronger appeal → higher conversion and loyalty → better sales and margins.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

The best target is the one that fits the business's objectives and strengths, not necessarily the largest.

Model 8 3.3.4 | The 7Ps

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

THE ELEMENTS

Product, price, promotion, place, people, process, physical environment.

The last three are especially important for services.

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Pick the one or two elements that matter most in the case and explain how they fit the target market.

For B2B and service questions, people and process often matter more than advertising.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

A checklist to make sure all parts of the offer are considered.

Helps build an integrated mix where each element supports the others.

LIMITATIONS

Seen from the seller's point of view rather than the customer's.

Lists elements but does not show which matters most.

Elements overlap.

EXAM TRAP

Don't describe all seven Ps. Choose the elements that are relevant to the question and the case.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Well-trained staff (people) + quick ordering (process) → better customer experience → loyalty → repeat sales and premium pricing.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

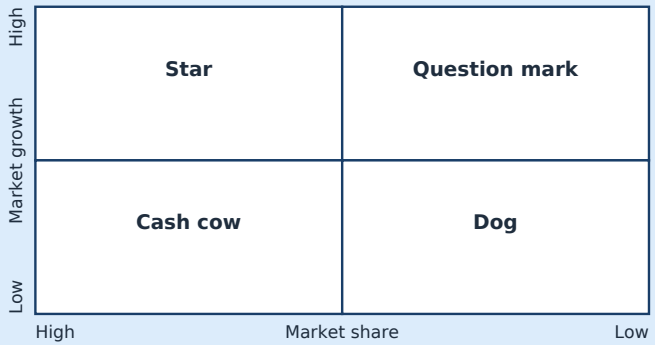
Judge whether the mix is integrated - one element that doesn't fit can undermine the rest.

Model 9 3.3.4 | Boston Matrix

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

Products placed by market share and market growth.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Place the products in the case, then discuss cash flow across the portfolio: cash cows can fund question marks and stars.

Ask whether the portfolio is balanced.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Shows the balance of a product portfolio.

Helps decide where to invest and where to withdraw.

Links to the product life cycle and cash flow.

LIMITATIONS

A snapshot at one time.

Market definition affects where a product sits.

Dogs can still be profitable or support other products.

EXAM TRAP

Don't recommend dropping every dog or assume every star is highly profitable.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Cash cow funds promotion of a question mark → share grows → becomes a star → portfolio stays balanced as the cash cow declines.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

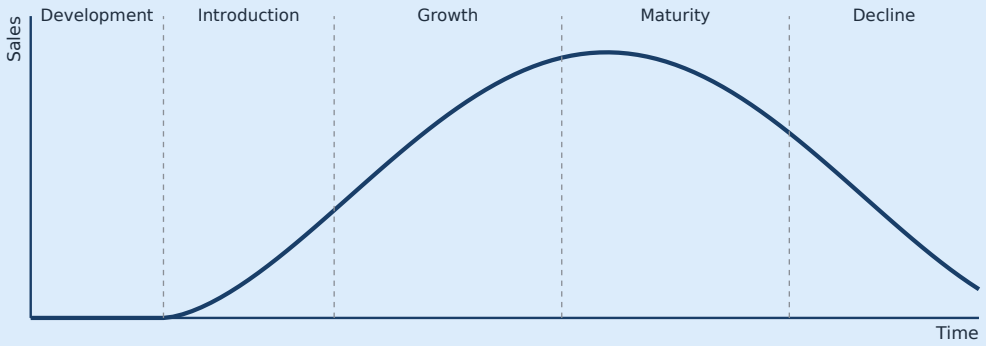
Use the matrix to raise questions, then decide using the contribution and prospects of each product.

Model 10 3.3.4 | Product Life Cycle

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WHAT IT SHOWS

Sales over time through five stages.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify the stage of the product in the case and its likely cash flow, competition and promotional needs.

Use it to discuss extension strategies or new product development.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Helps plan marketing and investment at each stage.

Shows when extension strategies or replacements are needed.

Links to cash flow and the Boston Matrix.

LIMITATIONS

Not every product follows the curve.

Stage lengths cannot be predicted.

Decline can be caused by the business's own decisions.

EXAM TRAP

The life cycle is a model, not a timetable or a forecast.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Product enters maturity → extension strategy (new market) → sales revived → cash generated for new products.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

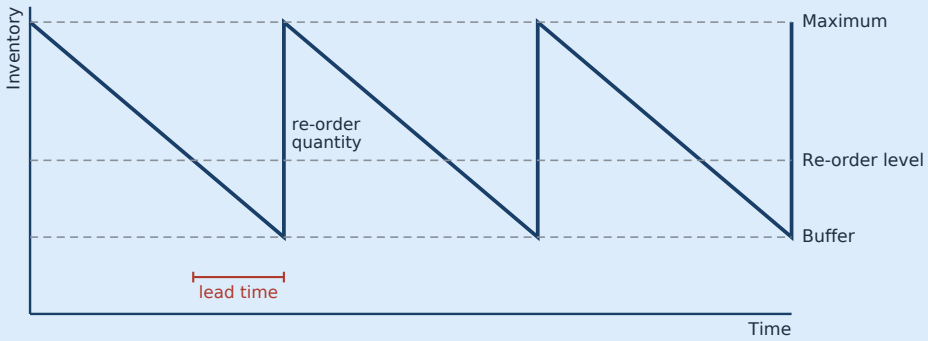
Judge whether falling sales are a true decline or the result of the business's marketing choices.

Model 11 3.4.5 | Inventory Control Chart

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WHAT IT SHOWS

Inventory falling with use and rising with each delivery.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Read off buffer inventory, re-order level, re-order quantity, maximum level and lead time.

Explain what would happen if lead time increased or usage rose.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Helps plan when and how much to order.

Shows the risk of running out.

Links to cash flow - inventory ties up cash.

LIMITATIONS

Assumes usage and lead time are steady.

Real demand and deliveries vary.

Does not show the cost of holding inventory.

EXAM TRAP

The re-order level is above buffer inventory. The order is placed at the re-order level so it arrives before the buffer is used.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Lead time increases → re-order level must rise → more inventory held → more cash tied up.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

The right level of inventory balances the cost of holding it against the cost of running out.

Model 12 3.6.4 | Taylor - Scientific Management

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

THE THEORY

Workers are motivated mainly by money and want to earn as much as possible.

Managers should study each task, find the one best way of doing it, train workers in that method, and pay them by output (piece rate).

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Most relevant for simple, repetitive tasks where output can be measured for each worker.

Links to piece rate, division of labour and close supervision.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Can raise productivity and lower unit costs.

Clear methods and targets.

LIMITATIONS

Ignores social and personal needs.

Repetitive work can be boring, raising absence and labour turnover.

Quality may suffer when pay depends on quantity.

Less relevant to skilled, creative or service work.

EXAM TRAP

Taylor is about money and efficiency through close control. Don't use Taylor to support empowerment or team working.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Piece rate introduced → workers produce more to earn more → productivity rises → unit costs fall → but quality checks may be needed.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

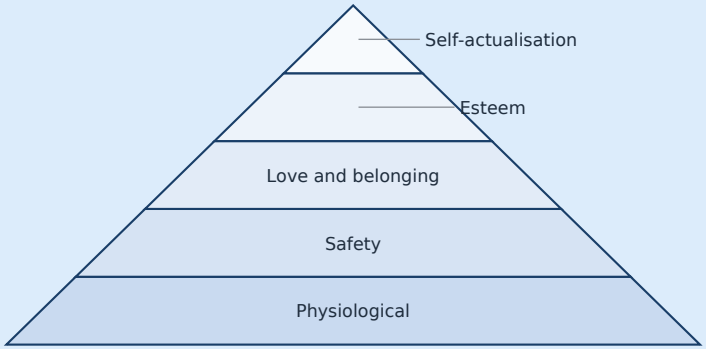
Judge Taylor's approach by the type of work. It may suit a packing line but not a design studio.

Model 13 3.6.4 | Maslow - Hierarchy of Needs

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

THE HIERARCHY

Needs are met from the bottom up.



HOW IT WORKS

Lower needs must be satisfied before higher needs motivate.

Once a need is met, it no longer motivates - the next level up does.

Examples at work: pay (physiological), job security (safety), teams (social), recognition (esteem), challenging work (self-actualisation).

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify where staff in the case are likely to be and which need the business should now target.

E.g. staff with secure, well-paid jobs are likely to be motivated by recognition and responsibility.

LIMITATIONS

Hard to know which level an individual is at.

People may not move through the levels in order.

Some needs, like self-actualisation, are never fully met.

EXAM TRAP

Explain the hierarchy - lower needs come first and a satisfied need stops motivating. Just listing the five levels earns little.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Redundancies announced → staff feel their safety needs are threatened → higher needs no longer motivate → morale and productivity fall.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Use the case to judge which need is unmet for these staff now, then recommend a method that targets it.

Model 14 3.6.4 | Herzberg - Two-Factor Theory

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

HYGIENE FACTORS

Pay, working conditions, company policy, supervision, relationships at work, job security.

If poor, they cause dissatisfaction. Improving them removes dissatisfaction but does not motivate.

MOTIVATORS

Achievement, recognition, the work itself, responsibility, advancement.

These come from the job itself and lead to real motivation.

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

First check hygiene factors are adequate, then recommend motivators such as job enrichment or empowerment.

Use it to question whether a pay rise will motivate.

LIMITATIONS

Based on a small original study of professional workers.

Pay can act as recognition, so the line between the factors is blurred.

Some staff may not want more responsibility.

EXAM TRAP

Pay is a hygiene factor. It stops dissatisfaction but does not motivate - one of the most common errors in exam answers.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Job enrichment adds responsibility → staff feel trusted and challenged (motivators) → greater commitment → higher productivity and quality.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Judge whether hygiene factors are already met in the case. If not, motivators will have little effect until they are.

Model 15 3.7.1 | SWOT Analysis

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

Internal strengths and weaknesses; external opportunities and threats.

Internal	**Strengths**	**Weaknesses**
External	**Opportunities**	**Threats**

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Pick the most important factor in each box from the case.

Then link them: how can a strength be used to take an opportunity or counter a threat?

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Quick, simple overview of the strategic position.

Brings internal and external analysis together.

Starting point for choosing a strategy.

LIMITATIONS

Lists factors without weighting them.

Can be subjective.

A snapshot that quickly goes out of date.

Does not tell the business what to do.

EXAM TRAP

Opportunities and threats are external. A business's own plans are not opportunities.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Strong brand (strength) + growing overseas demand (opportunity) → market development abroad → brand helps win customers quickly → sales growth.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

The value of SWOT lies in deciding which factors matter most, not in the list itself.

Model 16 3.7.3 | Elkington's Triple Bottom Line

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THE THREE MEASURES

Profit - financial performance.

People - effect on employees, communities, suppliers and society.

Planet - environmental impact.

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Use it to assess performance more broadly than profit, especially for social enterprises or businesses with ethical aims.

Weigh gains on one measure against costs on another.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Encourages a long-term, wider view of success.

Can strengthen reputation and appeal to customers, staff and investors.

LIMITATIONS

People and planet are hard to measure and compare with profit.

The three measures can conflict.

Can be used as a PR exercise.

EXAM TRAP

The Triple Bottom Line is a way of measuring performance, not just a commitment to being green. Use all three measures.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Social enterprise reports on all three measures → shows its social and environmental impact → attracts grants, customers and staff who share its values.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

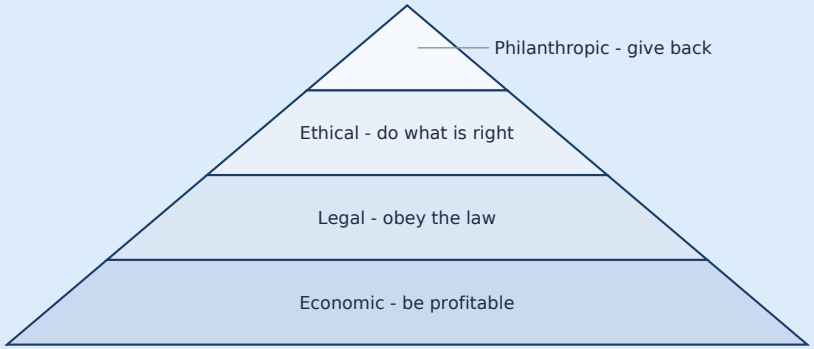
Judge how far the business genuinely measures and acts on people and planet, and what trade-offs with profit it accepts.

Model 17 3.7.6 | Carroll's CSR Pyramid

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

Four levels of responsibility, from the base up.



THE FOUR LEVELS

Economic - be profitable; the foundation for everything else.

Legal - obey the law.

Ethical - do what is right, fair and just, beyond the law.

Philanthropic - contribute to the community, e.g. donations and volunteering.

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify which levels the business in the case is meeting and which it is not.

Use it to argue that a business must stay profitable to afford its wider responsibilities.

LIMITATIONS

Responsibilities can conflict, e.g. economic v ethical.

What counts as ethical differs between people and countries.

Does not show how to balance the levels.

EXAM TRAP

Economic responsibility is at the base, not the top. Philanthropy is the top level.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Business meets economic and legal responsibilities → invests in ethical sourcing → stronger reputation → customer loyalty → supports long-term profit.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

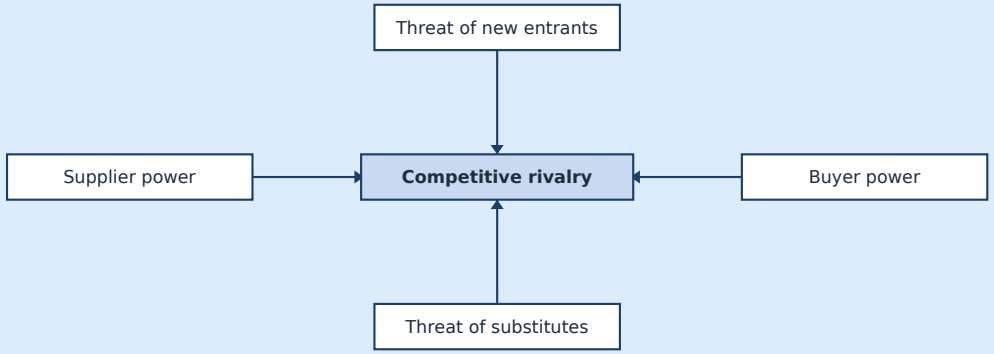
Judge whether CSR activity is genuine and whether it fits the business's strategy and finances.

Model 18 3.7.7 | Porter's Five Forces

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WHAT IT SHOWS

Five forces that determine competition and profitability.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Say whether each relevant force is strong or weak in the case and why.

Explain what that means for prices and profit, and how the business could respond.

Credited in answers on integration - e.g. backward vertical integration reduces supplier power.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Assesses how attractive a market is.

Helps choose markets and strategy.

Shows how to improve the business's position.

LIMITATIONS

A snapshot - forces change.

Hard to measure each force.

Focuses on competition, not cooperation between firms.

EXAM TRAP

Don't just list the forces. Judge the strength of each and explain its effect on profit.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Low barriers to entry → new rivals enter → more competition → prices and margins fall.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Identify which force matters most for the business in the case and how it might change.

Model 19 3.7.8 | Investment Appraisal

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PAYBACK

Time for net cash flows to cover the initial cost.

Part year: amount still needed ÷ next year's net cash flow × 12 months.

Simple, focuses on risk and cash; ignores later cash flows.

AVERAGE RATE OF RETURN

ARR (%) = average annual return ÷ initial cost × 100.

Average annual return = (total net cash flows - initial cost) ÷ years.

Uses all cash flows; ignores timing.

NET PRESENT VALUE

Each year's net cash flow × discount factor = present value.

NPV = total present values - initial cost. Positive = worthwhile at that rate.

Takes account of timing; depends on the discount rate chosen.

OTHER FACTORS

Investment criteria set by the business.

Non-financial factors - strategy, staff, ethics, environment.

Risk and uncertainty - forecasts may be wrong.

EXAM TRAP

For ARR, subtract the initial cost from the total net cash flows first. Only about one in five students did this correctly in a recent exam.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Positive NPV and payback within target → project meets the business's criteria → investment goes ahead → returns increase, if forecasts are accurate.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Combine the results with non-financial factors and judge how reliable the forecasts are.

Model 20 3.8.1 | Ansoff's Matrix

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

Four growth options, by existing or new products and markets.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify which option the business in the case is considering.

Explain the risk involved and whether the business has the resources and knowledge to succeed.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Sets out growth options clearly.

Shows how risk rises with unfamiliarity.

LIMITATIONS

Does not say which option to choose.

'New' can mean slightly new or completely new - risk varies.

Ignores competitors' responses.

EXAM TRAP

Diversification is the riskiest option for the business's knowledge - but it can reduce overall risk by spreading it across markets.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Market penetration through promotion → more sales from existing customers → low risk → but limited if the market is saturated.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

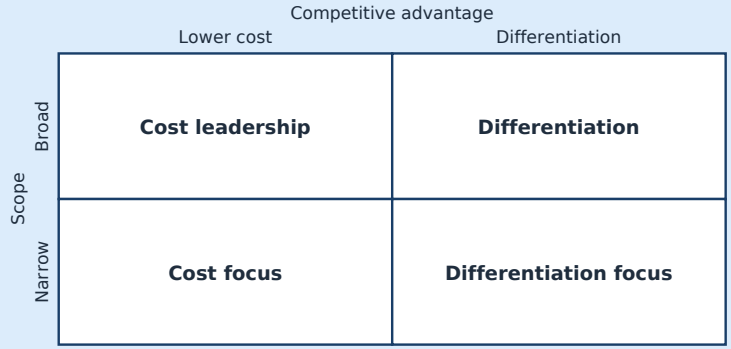
Judge which option fits the business's resources, objectives and attitude to risk.

Model 21 3.8.2 | Porter's Generic Strategies

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

Competing on cost or differentiation, broadly or in a focused segment.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify the strategy the business in the case follows and whether its decisions support it.

Ask whether it is at risk of being stuck in the middle.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Clarifies how a business competes.

Guides functional decisions.

Can be linked to the five forces.

LIMITATIONS

Some businesses succeed with low cost and differentiation together.

A strategy can be copied.

Does not show how to achieve the advantage.

EXAM TRAP

Cost leadership means lowest costs, not lowest prices.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Cost leadership → lowest unit costs → can match rivals' prices with higher margins → funds for further investment.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

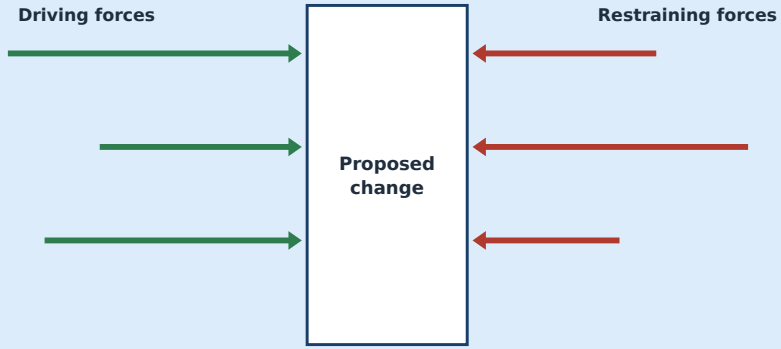
Judge whether the advantage is sustainable and whether functional decisions support it.

Model 22 3.10.1 | Lewin's Force Field Analysis

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

Driving forces for change against restraining forces.



USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify the driving and restraining forces in the case and weight them.

Recommend how to strengthen drivers or reduce restraints.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Shows why change is or is not happening.

Helps plan how to manage change.

Encourages managers to think about resistance early.

LIMITATIONS

Weighting forces is subjective.

Forces change during the process.

Simplifies complex situations.

EXAM TRAP

Reducing restraining forces is often more effective than pushing harder with driving forces, which can increase resistance.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Staff fear job losses (restraining force) → managers guarantee redeployment → restraint weakened → change goes ahead with less resistance.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Weigh the forces in the case and judge whether the change is likely to succeed.

Model 23 3.10.1 | Kotter and Schlesinger

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

FOUR REASONS FOR RESISTANCE

Parochial self-interest.

Misunderstanding and lack of trust.

Different assessments of the situation.

Low tolerance for change.

SIX WAYS OF OVERCOMING RESISTANCE

Education and communication.

Participation and involvement.

Facilitation and support.

Negotiation and agreement.

Manipulation and co-optation.

Explicit and implicit coercion.

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify the most likely reason for resistance in the case.

Choose the method that matches it, considering time, power and risk.

LIMITATIONS

Real resistance often has several causes.

Manipulation and coercion raise ethical concerns and can damage trust.

Methods take time and money.

EXAM TRAP

Match the method to the cause. Communication won't overcome resistance from staff who will genuinely lose out.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Resistance due to misunderstanding → education and communication → staff understand the reasons → resistance falls → change implemented faster.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Weigh speed against long-term trust when choosing a method.

Model 24 3.10.2 | Handy's Organisational Cultures

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

POWER CULTURE

Power held by one person or a small group at the centre. Fast decisions; depends on the leader.

ROLE CULTURE

Based on rules, procedures and job roles. Stable and predictable; slow to change.

TASK CULTURE

Teams formed around projects; expertise matters most. Flexible and creative; hard to control.

PERSON CULTURE

The organisation exists to serve the individuals in it, e.g. some partnerships of professionals.

Limitations of the model - most businesses mix cultures, and culture varies between departments.

EXAM TRAP

Culture is about values and behaviour, not the structure chart.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Role culture → strict procedures → slow response to change → strategic drift.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

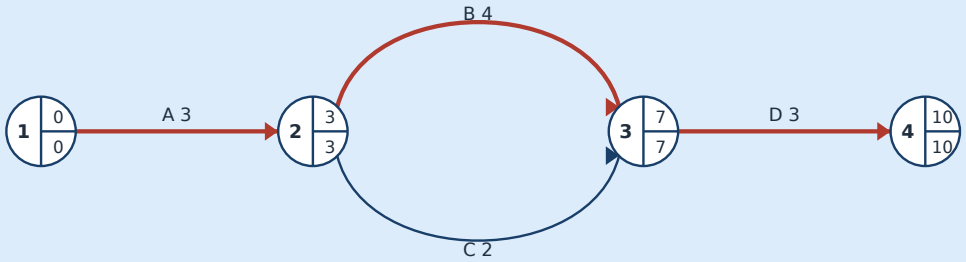
Judge whether the culture in the case supports the strategy, and how long it would take to change it.

Model 25 3.10.3 | Network Analysis

AQA A-LEVEL BUSINESS 7132 - BUSINESS MODELS AND THEORIES

WHAT IT SHOWS

Activities, their order and durations; EST and LFT at each node.



Node: number | EST (top) | LFT (bottom). Critical path in red.

USING IT IN AN ANSWER

Identify the critical path and its length.

Total float = LFT - duration - EST.

Refer to specific activities on the diagram, e.g. which are critical and what a delay would do.

WHAT IT IS USEFUL FOR

Shows the minimum project time.

Identifies activities that must not be delayed.

Helps plan resources and spot flexibility.

LIMITATIONS

Durations are estimates.

Needs updating as things change.

Does not ensure activities are done well or on time.

EXAM TRAP

Answers that don't refer to the diagram score poorly. Name the activities and use the figures.

ANALYSIS CHAIN

Critical activity delayed → whole project delayed → extra costs and possible penalties.

TOP GRADE CONNECTION

Judge how reliable the duration estimates are and what happens if a critical activity overruns.